

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$378.04 ▼ 0.23%	12M Price Target \$420.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.49T
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TSLA: FSD Faith Meets Massive Put Wall at \$380

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA is basically flat today (\$378, -0.23%) but sitting near the top of a 4-day bounce off \$364. The real story is the Ron Baron confirmation that Druckenmiller's big Tesla buy was a Full Self-Driving (FSD) bet — meaning smart money is treating this like an AI stock, not a car stock. That's why it's holding up even as EV demand headlines soften.
- Massive put buying at \$380/\$382.50 strikes expiring this week — 144K contracts at \$380 alone, notional value \$30M+. Translation: someone big is either betting the stock drops fast in the next few days, or hedging a large long position. Either way, \$380 is now a battleground level.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is weird: options flow screams bearish short-term (put/call ratio 0.59 with unusual put volume 90x normal open interest), but the stock is grinding higher on the AI/FSD narrative. This probably means we're in a tug-of-war between traders positioning for a September expiry pin at \$380 and longer-term believers accumulating on the robotaxi story. The Trump-Xi dinner tonight is the wildcard — Tesla makes about a third of its cars in Shanghai and sells a huge chunk there, so any tone shift on tariffs or tech transfer restrictions hits TSLA harder than any other US automaker. If the meeting goes well, the puts get crushed and we squeeze toward \$400; if it sours, that put wall becomes a magnet down to \$360.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

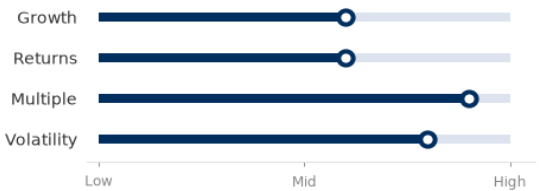
The \$7,500 federal EV tax credit expired September 30, 2025 under the "One Big Beautiful Bill" — meaning Tesla just lapped its first full year without that subsidy, and Q3 numbers (due mid-October) will be the first clean read on demand without it. On the other side, the Trump administration's push to loosen federal autonomous vehicle rules (NHTSA is drafting a national AV framework to preempt the state-by-state mess) is a direct tailwind for FSD and robotaxi — if that framework drops this fall, it removes the single biggest regulatory obstacle to Tesla's AI thesis. Watch the Xi dinner tonight for any China auto tariff signals — Tesla is uniquely exposed both ways.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$378.04
12M Price Target	\$420.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.1%
Market Cap	\$1.49T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$135M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.45
FY2027E EPS	\$3.60
Fwd P/E	154.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$410.00	\$380.00	\$345.00
6 Months	\$475.00	\$400.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$550.00	\$420.00	\$280.00
2 Years	\$700.00	\$475.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$1000.00	\$600.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$850.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.29%) and Industrials — the trade/China meeting has commodity plays perking up on the "deal gets done" bet. Anything tied to physical AI infrastructure buildout is bid.

COOLING OFF: Energy (-4.93% over 5 days) getting hammered on oil weakness, and Tech is taking a breather (-0.20% today) after a big +5.96% week — some profit-taking into quarter-end.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from pure software AI names into AI-hardware and physical-AI plays (robotics, autonomous vehicles, energy grid). That's a direct tailwind for TSLA because it sits at the intersection of all three.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the FSD/robotaxi thesis, the picks-and-shovels play is NVDA (still supplies Tesla's training compute) and lidar/sensor names — though ironically Tesla's vision-only approach hurts the pure lidar plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the primary beneficiary of every AI capex dollar, including Tesla's Dojo/training buildout.
- GEV (GE Vernova): Riding the "AI needs power" trade — data center electricity demand is a real bipartisan tailwind.

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is lagging pure-play AI names but leading legacy auto (Ford dipped today on the Xi dinner snub story). That tells you the market is already treating TSLA as a hybrid — it's not going to run like NVDA, but it also won't get crushed like Ford on auto-specific bad news. It trades on its own narrative, which cuts both ways.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$340-355 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: FSD unsupervised rollout delayed past 2027 or China deliveries drop >20% YoY

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair with a legacy auto short (F/GM)